

157 It Came upon the Midnight Clear

1. It came up-on the mid-night clear, that glo-rious song of old,
 2. Still through the clo-ven skies they come, with peace-ful wings un-furled,
 3. And ye, be-neath life's crush-ing load, whose forms are bend-ing low,
 4. For lo, the days are has-t'ning on, by proph-et bards fore-told,

from an-gels bend-ing near the earth to touch their harps of gold:
 and still their heav'n-ly mu-sic floats o'er all the wea-ry world:
 who toil a-long the climb-ing way with pain-ful steps and slow,
 when with the ev-er-cir-cle years comes round the age of gold;

"Peace on the earth, good will to men, from heav'n's all-gra-cious King";
 a-bove its sad and low-ly plains they bend on hov'-ring wing,
 look now! for glad and gold-en hours come swift-ly on the wing:
 when peace shall o-ver all the earth its an-cient splen-dors fling,

the world in sol-lemn still-ness lay to hear the an-gels sing.
 and ev-er o'er its Ba-bel sounds the bless-ed an-gels sing.
 O rest be-side the wea-ry road and hear the an-gels sing.
 and the whole world give back the song which now the an-gels sing.